11–18 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Line I Forgot at the English Recital

① Our school's annual English Recital is always held on the third Friday in November, 18:30, in the big sports hall. It is one of the bigger nights of the year for anyone who loves English — a black stage, two bright lights, a microphone on a thin silver stand, and three minutes of perfect, flowing English, memorised by heart, spoken out loud to more than four hundred pairs of ears. This year, for the first time, I was on the list. My piece was Robert Frost's poem "**The Road Not Taken**". I had been practising for six weeks — 184 times, according to the small tick-marks on the back of my notebook.

② On the afternoon of the recital, everything felt normal. I ate two small dumplings and a bowl of egg soup at 17:40. I zipped up my school blazer. I whispered the twenty lines of the poem to myself on the school bus with my eyes closed. At 18:05 I was already standing in the waiting area behind the heavy red curtain. My English teacher, Ms. Yu, walked past and said softly, "Remember, even if you forget, **keep breathing**. The audience does not hear silence as the end of the world; you do."

③ When my name was called — "**Number 12, Grade 8, Class 4, Lin Shuwen**" — my legs walked me across the black stage. The bright lights hit my eyes like two small suns. I reached the microphone, waited for the clapping to fade, took a breath, and began. "*Two roads diverged in a yellow wood, and sorry I could not travel both...*" The first eight lines came out smooth and warm. I could hear my own voice in the huge hall, slightly echoing off the back wall, and I felt, for a brief moment, like a real poet.

④ Then, at **line twelve**, my mind went **completely blank**.

⑤ I had practised this line a hundred and seventy times. "*Though as for that, the passing there* —" should have led me to "had worn them really about the same". My mouth opened. Nothing came out. The bright lights on the stage, suddenly, felt like the headlights of a car. My heart rose into my throat. Four hundred faces in the dark waited. I could hear the small electrical hum of the microphone. I could hear my own breath — very close, very fast.

⑥ For three long seconds I stood completely still. I thought about running. I thought about whispering "I'm sorry" and leaving the stage. I thought about my mother sitting in Row 14. Then, suddenly, **Ms. Yu's voice from the afternoon** came back to me: "*Keep breathing. The audience does not hear silence as the end of the world; you do.*" I took one slow breath. I did not look at the lights. I looked at the **middle button** of my own blazer, which was a small quiet thing that did not demand perfection from me.

⑦ I said, gently and clearly, to the whole hall: "**Please give me one more moment.**" My voice shook a little, but it was steady enough. A small laugh, warm and understanding, moved through the audience. I looked down, closed my eyes, whispered line eleven once to myself — and, like a small clean key turning in a lock, line twelve came back: "*Though as for that, the passing there / had worn them really about the same.*" I finished the rest of the poem. The final line, "*and that has made all the difference,*" felt, that night, **true** in a way I had never understood before.

⑧ When I walked off the stage, Ms. Yu was waiting behind the red curtain with a quiet smile. She said, "**That was not your most perfect recital. But it may have been your most important one.**" I did not fully understand until much later. The other twelve students on the list had all recited perfectly, without a single pause. I received the **"Honest Reader" award** — a small wooden bookmark, shaped like a tiny road forking into two, with Ms. Yu's careful handwriting on the back: "*A good reader does not only read when nothing goes wrong. She reads also when the wood is sorry.*"

⑨ The bookmark sits on my desk now, next to my English textbook. On busy evenings I sometimes look at it and think: the six weeks of practice did not guarantee a perfect recital. The three seconds of silent forgetting did not ruin it. What carried me across that stage was a **fourth gift** — a sentence from my teacher I had only half-listened to in the afternoon, and a middle button on my own blazer. I did not forget a line because I was weak. I remembered a line because I was **kindly held** — by a teacher, by an audience, by a small button, and, in the end, by myself. **That, too, has made all the difference.**

注释： recital 朗诵/演奏会；microphone 麦克风；poem 诗；line 诗行；bookmark 书签

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Which detail shows that the writer had prepared a LOT for the recital?

A. She took two dumplings on the afternoon of the recital.
B. She had been practising for six weeks — 184 times, according to the small tick-marks on the back of her notebook.
C. She wore a school blazer.
D. She got on the school bus at 18:05.

2. What exactly happened at line twelve of the poem?

A. The microphone broke.
B. The lights turned off.
C. The writer's mind went completely blank; she could not continue; she heard the microphone hum and her own fast breath while four hundred faces waited in the dark.
D. The audience laughed loudly.

3. What did the writer finally DO to recover on stage?

A. She ran off the stage.
B. She said to the hall, "Please give me one more moment," looked down, closed her eyes, whispered line eleven to herself, and line twelve came back.
C. She sang another song.
D. She asked the judge for a new poem.

4. What did Ms. Yu say to the writer backstage afterwards?

A. "You must practise 400 times next year."
B. "That was not your most perfect recital. But it may have been your most important one."
C. "You are banned from the next recital."
D. "Do not worry, no one heard."

5. Which sentence best captures the main lesson of the story?

A. A perfect recital is the only good recital.
B. The writer did not forget a line because she was weak; she remembered a line because she was kindly held — by a teacher's words, by an audience's warm laugh, by a small button on her blazer, and, in the end, by herself; small kindnesses can carry us through our hardest moments.
C. Students should never go on stage.
D. English recitals are a waste of time.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段末 "six weeks ... 184 times"
【解析】准备程度直引。A、C、D 均不相关。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④、⑤段舞台细节
【解析】忘词瞬间直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑦段 "Please give me one more moment ... line eleven ... line twelve came back"
【解析】自救过程直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑧段老师原话
【解析】直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第⑨段结论
【解析】被温柔托举的主题。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。